

The Door in the Orchard Wall: answers

Year 6 · 15 marks. Accept any sensible answer that is backed up by the text.

1. Faded blue (the blue of a summer sky). (1 mark)

Finding information (2b). A detail to find in the second paragraph.

2. crumbling (1 mark)

Word meaning (2a). Finding the word that shows the state of the wall builds vocabulary and attention to detail.

3. The door was so surprising or tempting that it made Mia break a rule she had always followed (curiosity was stronger than obedience). (2 marks)

Inference (2d). A short phrase that tells us a lot about a character and a turning point.

4. It makes the orchard seem alive, as if it is watching or waiting, which makes the scene mysterious or slightly frightening. (2 marks)

Language choices. Explaining the effect of a writer's choice, not just naming it.

5. "like lanterns lit from within". It suggests the fruit gave off a warm, magical glow. (2 marks)

Language choices. Spotting a simile and then saying what it suggests.

6. Any two of: the door appears suddenly; the strange smell; the glowing fruit; the door vanishing; the unseen humming. (2 marks)

Explaining from the text. Seeing how a writer builds an atmosphere out of small details.

7. One mark each for: Mia finds a door that was not there before; she goes through into a magical, glowing orchard and the door vanishes behind her; she hears humming and decides to follow it. (3 marks)

Summarising (2c). A summary keeps the main events and leaves out the descriptions.

8. Any sensible prediction supported by a clue, for example: someone who has been waiting a long time, because the humming sounds like "someone who had been waiting a very long time". (2 marks)

Giving a view with evidence. Predicting what happens next, and justifying it with a clue from the text.